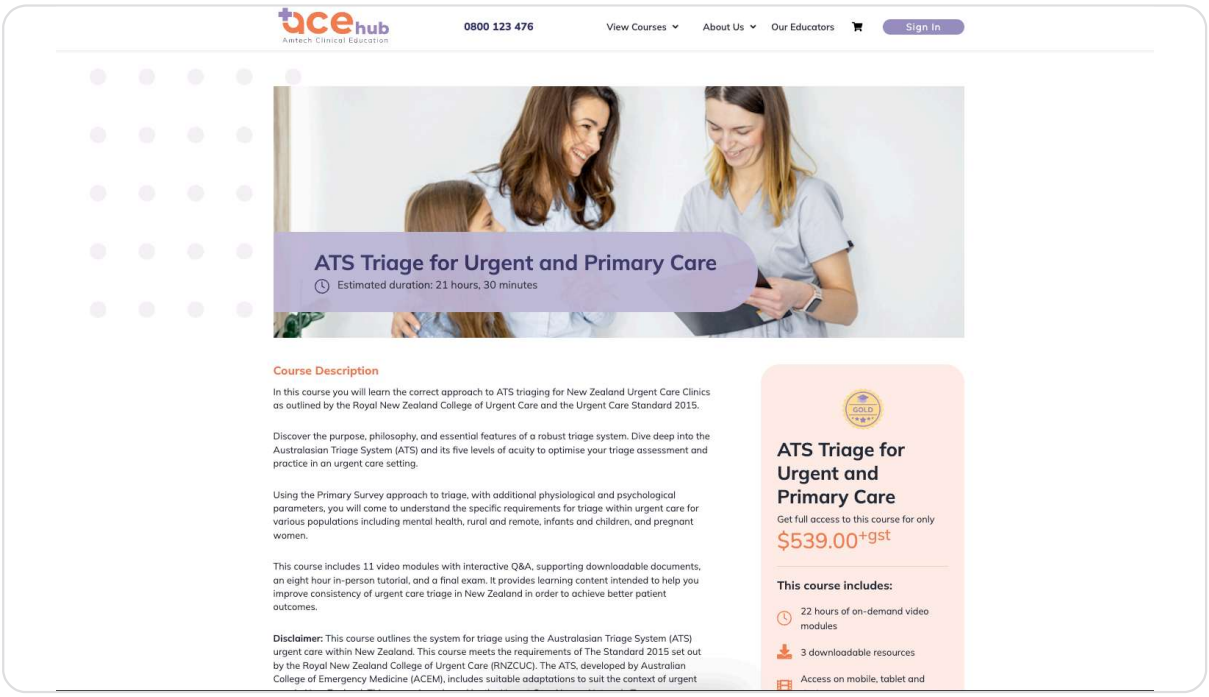
Exam Preparation

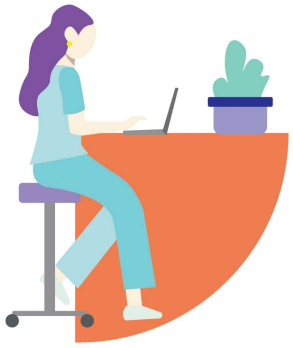
ATS Triage for Urgent and Primary Care



In order to prepare for your exam, there are some things you can do.

1 Revise module 11 in the ACEhub online course.





2 Review the three case studies at the end of each tutorial.

You can find them in your workbook. The answers are listed below.

Tutorial A

1. **Reese ATS 2** — Pain Priority
2. **Maree ATS 2** — Chest Pain + Palpitations + HR 162 with mild compromise in Pregnancy
3. **Elliot ATS 4** – Recently taken pain relief (give that time to work and then reassess)

Tutorial B

1. **Rosemary ATS 2** — Pain Priority
2. **Martin ATS 2** – Dislocation +/ – Fracture
3. **Cassandra ATS 1** – Airway management needed

Tutorial C

1. **Mohammed ATS 3** – Presence of bizarre behavior + delusions
2. **Bianca ATS 3** – Moderate Pain
3. **Remo ATS 3** – Even though he states only 4/10 pain renal colick is a very painful disease (humane reasons)

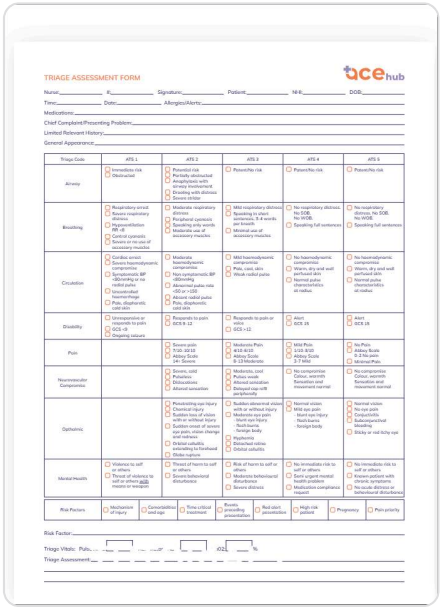
Tutorial D

1. **Lee ATS 3** – Paranoid Hallucinations
2. **Ann ATS 4** – Mild pain
3. **Adit ATS 2** – Breathing difficulty with Audible stridor at rest (airway compromise)

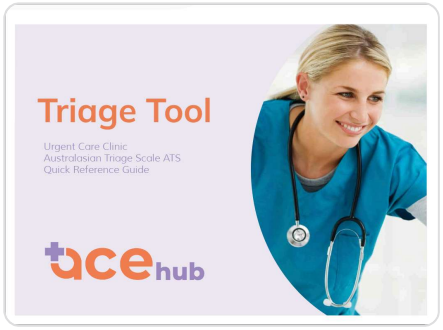
3

Remember to always use your Triage Assessment form, and your quick reference guide.

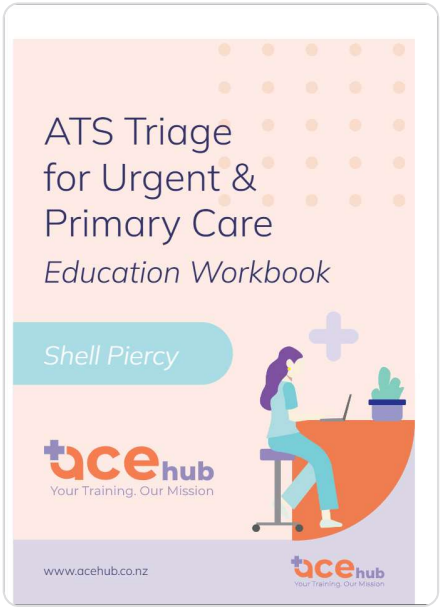
You can also use your triage tutorial workbook especially if you have written notes during your tutorials.



Triage Assessment Form



Triage Tool — Quick Reference Guide



Education Workbook



4

Remember, always start at ATS 5 in the primary triage assessment of patients.

Work towards ATS 1 if the parameters for each category are breached. Do not start at ATS 1. Do the same for Pain, Neurovascular, and Ophthalmology.

ATS 5 | ATS 4 | ATS 3 | ATS 2 | ATS 1

Paediatrics will be assessed that same way, starting at ATS 5 and when adverse findings occur work your way towards ATS 1.

The exception is Mental Health.

For Mental Health presentations always do a physiological triage first then assess Mental health starting at ATS 1 and working your way towards ATS 5 as you assess risk.

ATS 1 | ATS 2 | ATS 3 | ATS 4 | ATS 5

5

Use the triage tools available to you, not just the assessment form.

The form covers your legal documentation. For specifics of each parameter of A-D for different populations (eg. Children, Pregnancy, Pain, Opthalmological, etc), the details are in your triage tool.



6

Pain is assessed with three areas:

When triaging pain, utilize all three areas for an accurate triage score. This will also help you during your exam.

Subjective

What the patient says it is

Objective

What their vital signs show it is

Behaviour

> eg. Pt states the pain is 10/10, tachycardiac and tachypnoeic at triage, Patient guarding at triage.



7 Mental Health:

ATS 1 =	The patient has a weapon and the intention to use it.
ATS 2 =	The patient is agitated and aggressive or threatening and could use something in the waiting room to hurt themselves or someone else.
ATS 3 =	suicidal ideation or bizarre behavior or psychotic symptoms
ATS 4 =	not suicidal but has an acute mental health concern but will wait to be seen, should have a person with them
ATS 5 =	safe to wait, known patient. Re referral to services or medication compliance